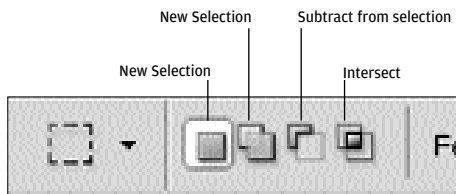


3.1.2 More Options

When you select the Marquee tools, the option bar at the top also changes to show you more options that you can tweak



The Option Bar for the Marquee Tool

when making your selections. The four buttons—New Selection, Add to Selection, Subtract from Selection, and Intersect—let you choose the way your next selection is going to behave.

You can also Feather the selection from the option bar—by feathering the selection, you will blur its edges so they won't appear so sharp when you make changes within the selection. Smaller pixel values will cause the edges to become smoother without losing any detail from your selection, while larger values will make the edges extremely fuzzy.

For more control over the selection, you can change the Style from the default Normal to either Fixed Aspect Ratio—where you can decide the ratio of the length to width of the selection—or Fixed Size, where you will use the mouse only to place the selection once you've set its size.

3.2 The Lasso Tools

For more flexibility when choosing the shape of your selection, you should use the Lasso tool  (Shortcut: [L] to select, [Shift]+[L] to cycle).

3.2.1 Drawing Selections

The default tool is the Lasso, which lets you draw your own freehand selection. By default, the cursor takes the shape of a rope lasso, which can sometimes be confusing, especially when you're trying to draw precise selections. To show the "precise" cursor for this tool, turn on [Caps Lock], which will turn the cursor into a crosshair. When you make the selection, you can either loop it all the way around, or let the boundary close itself by just releasing the mouse